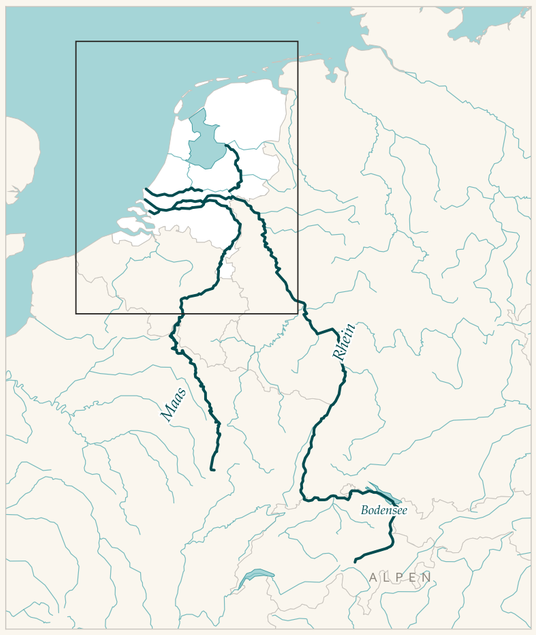
NEDERLAND · RIVERS, CANALS AND THE LAND BELOW THE SEA

26 % of the Netherlands lies below sea level

The Rhine, the Maas and the Schelde reach the North Sea across a delta of polders. Hatched: the 8 970 km² of land below NAP, the Dutch sea-level datum, 26.4 % of the ground measured by AHN4 laser altimetry. Rivers, main canals and lakes over height contours



WHERE THE WATER COMES FROM

The Rhine rises in the Swiss Alps, the Maas in north-east France; the rectangle is the extent of the main map

WADDENZEE
Terschelling
Ameland
Schiermonnikoog
Lauwersmeer
Eems
EMDEN
Delfzijl
Dollard
Van Starkenborghkanaal
GRONINGEN
LEEUWARDEN
Harlingen
FRYSLÂN
Texel
Afsluitdijk
Sneek
Prinses Margrietkanaal
Den Helder
Heerenveen
ASSEN
Stadskanaal
IJsselmeer
DRENTHE
Steenwijk
Emmen
NOORD-HOLLAND
Alkmaar
Hoorn
Meppel
FLEVOLAND
Markermeer
Kampen
Zwarte Water
ZWOLLE
Vecht
Hardenberg
LELYSTAD
Noordzeekanaal
HAARLEM
AMSTERDAM
ALMERE
IJssel
NORDHORN
OVERIJSSEL
VELUWE
Hengelo
Deventer
APELDOORN
Twentekanaal
ENSCHEDE
Hilversum
Amersfoort
Zutphen
Leiden
Amsterdam-Rijnkanaal
DEN HAAG
ZUID-HOLLAND
UTRECHT
GELDERLAND
Gouda
Delft
lowest ground –6.8 m
ARNHEM
Lek
Nederrijn
Wageningen
IJsselkop
Doetinchem
Winterswijk
ROTTERDAM
Tiel
Waal
Linge
Gorinchem
Pannerdensche Kop
NIJMEGEN
BOCHOLT
Dordrecht
Oss
Haringvliet
Maas
Rhein
DEUTSCHLAND
Grevelingen
Zierikzee
Bergsche Maas
Hollandsch Diep
'S-HERTOGENBOSCH
Lippe
WESEL
Oosterschelde
Dommel
BREDA
TILBURG
MIDDELBURG
Goes
Bergen op Zoom
Helmond
Vlissingen
NOORD-BRABANT
EINDHOVEN
DUISBURG
ESSEN
Westerschelde
DE PEEL
Venlo
ZEELAND
Terneuzen
KREFELD
OOSTENDE
BRUGGE
ANTWERPEN
DÜSSELDORF
MÖNCHENGLADBACH
Roermond
Schelde
Roer
GENT
MECHELEN
Sittard
KÖLN
HASSELT
Heerlen
LEUVEN
MAASTRICHT
BRUSSEL
AACHEN
Vaalserberg 322 m
BONN
LIÈGE
BELGIË
Meuse

Land below sea level (NAP 0 m), hatched
More than 4 m below, cross-hatched
Height contours: –5, 0, 5, 20, 50 m, then every 100 m
Rhine, Maas and Schelde: the delta's main branches
Rivers of 25 km and more; canals for large ships
Smaller rivers and canals
Rivers beyond the border
Where the Rhine splits in three

0 10 20 30 40 50 km

Scale 1 : 763 000 at 52° N; Mercator projection

3° E 4° E 5° E 6° E 7° E
53° N 52° N 51° N

Data: © OpenStreetMap contributors (ODbL), via Overpass; AHN4 DTM, Rijkswaterstaat and Het Waterschapshuis, via PDOK (CC0); AWS Terrain Tiles (SRTM, GMTED, ETOPO1; Mapzen); Natural Earth (public domain). Mercator projection · netherlands_rivers.py · git 4c16514